

HOUSING HIPPO

Empowering Students with
Rental Education

Group 1: Addia, Chloe, Jolina, Judy, Pauline



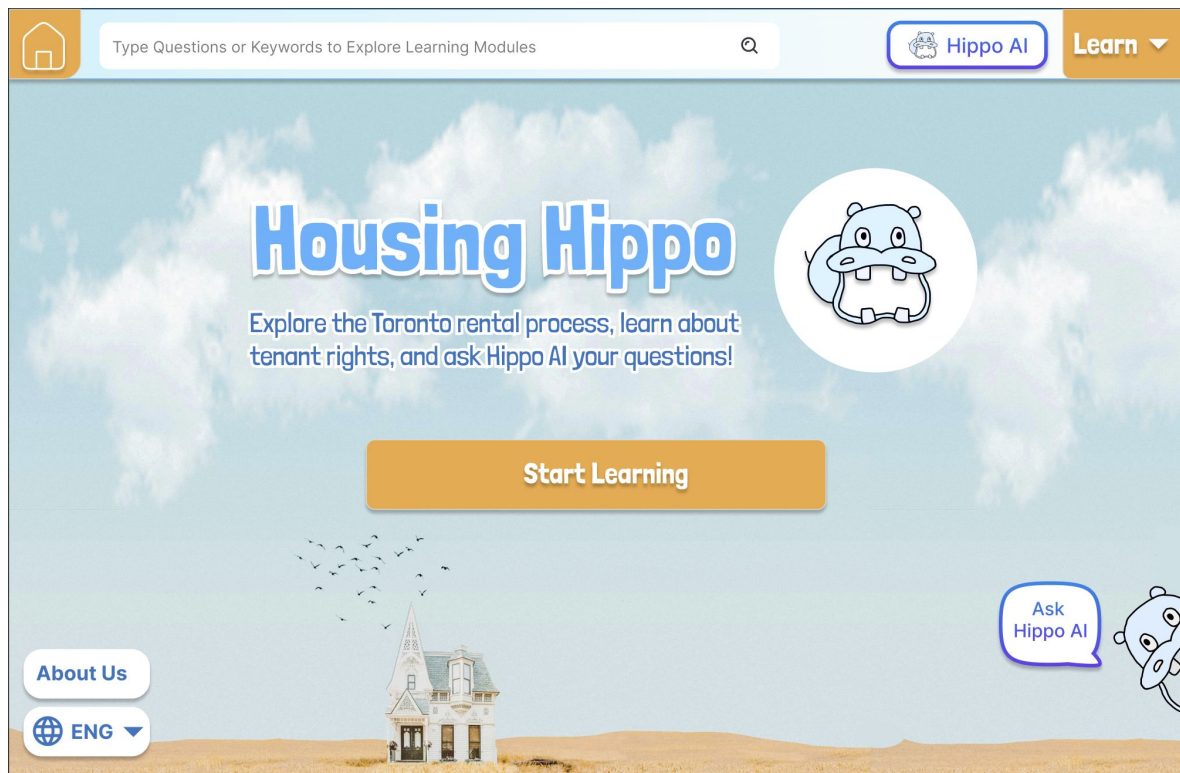
Have you ever had problems related to housing?



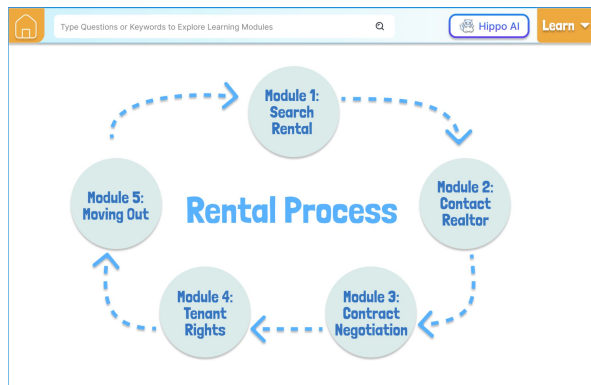
(ChatGPT, 2024)

OUR SOLUTION

An all-in-one educational
housing platform



MODULES



← Rental Process

Module 1: Search Rental

In this module, you will learn:

- 1.1 Where to Find Housing
- 1.2 Different Housing Types in Toronto
- 1.3 How to Identify a Scam

Start

← Module 1: Search Rental

1.2: Housing types in Toronto

Click each housing type.



Apartment



Condo



Shared House

- Standard lease agreement governed by Residential Tenancies Act (RTA).
- Landlords are generally responsible for maintenance and repairs.

← 1.1 Where to Find Housing 1.3 How to Identify a Scam →

← Module 1: Search Rental

1.3: How to Identify a Scam

Read and answer the question. Click "Reset" if it is wrong.

RESET

The landlord, who is out of town, asks for a deposit to view the apartment via wire transfer. What should you do?



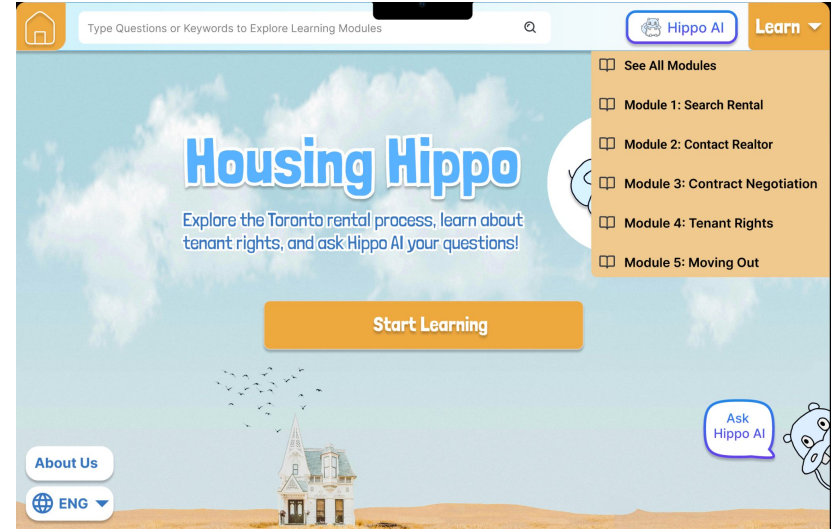
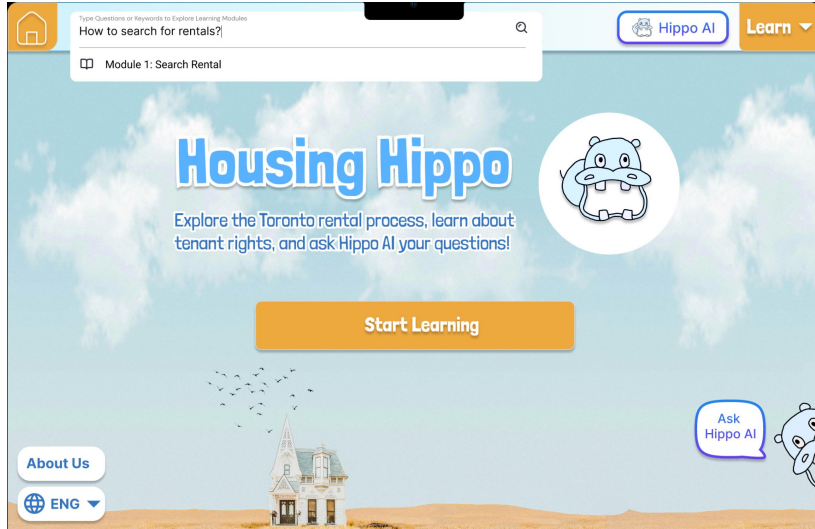
\$1000/month

- A) Wire the Deposit
- B) Ask for a Video Call
- C) Request an In-Person Visit
- D) Report the Listing

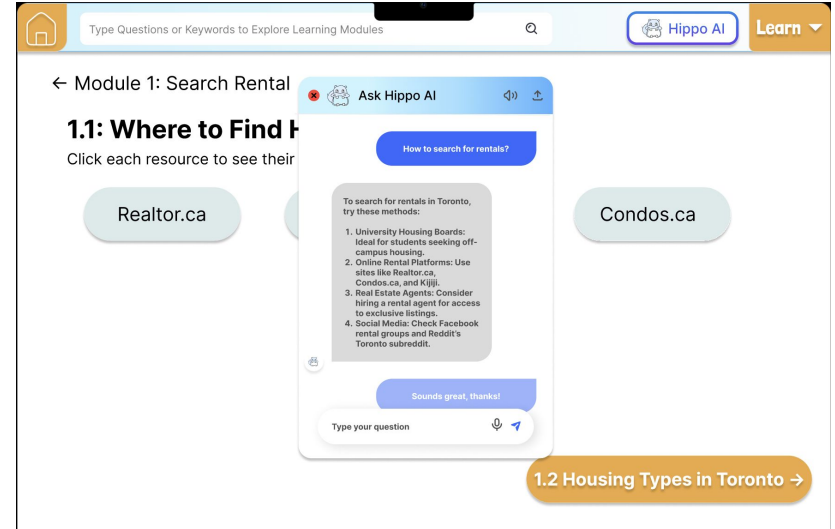
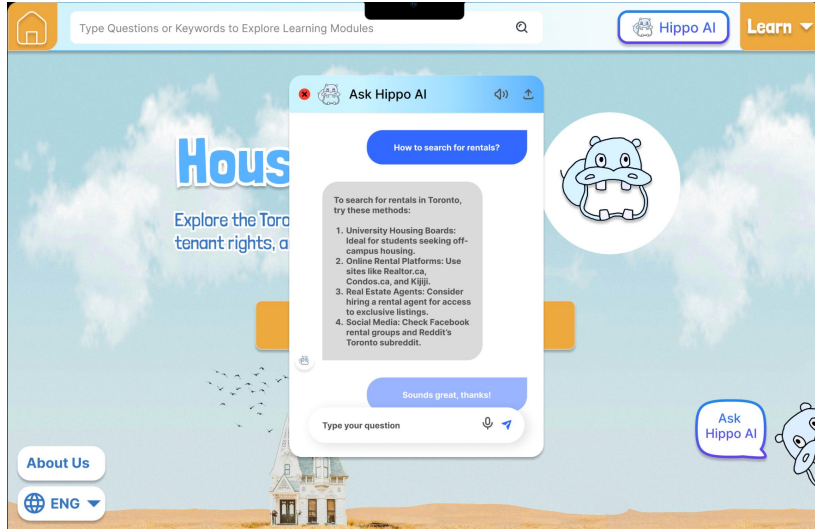
Protects others from falling victim to the same scam.
Can report to local authorities, rental platforms, or consumer protection agencies.

← 1.2 Housing Types in Toronto **Finish**

SEARCH BAR & MENU



HIPPO AI



WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?

Overwhelming Filters

ex: realtor.ca

The screenshot shows the realtor.ca search interface. A search bar at the top contains the placeholder text "City, Neighbourhood, Address or MLS® number". Below the search bar is a modal window with various filters. The filters are organized into several sections: Transaction Type (For sale, For rent, Sold), Property Type (Any), Min Rent (0), Max Rent (Unlimited), Beds (Any), Baths (Any), Land Size (Any), Listed Since (mm/dd/yyyy), Building Type (Any), Storeys (Any), Ownership/Title (Any), Year Built (Any), and Keywords (Waterfront, Garage, Pool...). There are also checkboxes for "Open Houses Only" and "Live Streams Only". At the bottom of the modal are "Reset" and "Search" buttons. The background shows a map of Toronto with various locations marked.

REALTOR.ca Residential Commercial CAD Sign In

City, Neighbourhood, Address or MLS® number

Transaction Type: ☐ For sale ☒ For rent ☐ Sold

Property Type: Any

Min Rent: 0 Max Rent: Unlimited Beds: Any Baths: Any

Land Size: Any Listed Since: mm/dd/yyyy Building Type: Any Storeys: Any

Ownership/Title: Any Year Built: Any ☐ Open Houses Only ☐ Live Streams Only

Keywords: Waterfront, Garage, Pool...

Reset Search

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?

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Our Simple Interface



WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?

Current User Experience

ex: UofT Housing Website

YOUR RENTAL SEARCH

There are lots of platforms that you can use to search for housing. We specifically recommend using the U of T [Off-campus Housing Finder](#), as these landlords are explicitly willing to rent to students. Use the filters to search for units that match your budget, desired neighbourhood and personal preferences. Once logged in, it doubles as a roommate search tool to find other U of T students who would like a roommate.

ATTENDING A VIEWING

Viewing a unit is important to [avoid scams](#) and ensure the unit suits your needs. Ask for a virtual viewing (a live video tour is ideal), come early to Toronto, or ask a trusted individual or a realtor to assist you. You can use our [Apartment Viewing Checklist](#) (PDF) to assess the unit.

We suggest you ask for a live (i.e. in-person or video) tour to ensure the unit is as advertised. Request photos and floor plans, inquire about the unit's amenities and safety, and make sure you know who the landlord is and their contact information (phone number and email are best). Reference our [Landlord Q&A](#) (PDF) for a list of key questions.

MAKING A RENTAL APPLICATION

When submitting an application, you should arrange to provide your full name and contact information, proof of employment, proof of income, references from previous landlords, and previous address.

SIGNING A LEASE

Landlords can only legally request [last month's rent and a refundable key deposit up front](#), and should not ask for application fees, security/damage deposits, cleaning fees, etc. This is true even if you are an international student. While you can choose to offer more than one month's rent, a landlord cannot legally ask you for more than one month's advance deposit.

tenant rights.

Contact Us

Paloma Bertossi

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Katrina Persad (on
leave)

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Related Content

[Steps to Justice](#)



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Related Content

[Steps to Justice](#)



Our User Experience



← Module 1: Search Rental

1.2: Housing types in Toronto

Click each housing type.



Apartment



Condo



Ontario law that outlines the rights and responsibilities of tenants and landlords, including rent, maintenance, and rights.

- Governed under [Condominium Act](#) Ⓢ
- Standard lease agreement governed by Residential Tenancies Act ([RTA](#) Ⓢ), exceptions may apply.
- Managed by a [Condominium Board](#) Ⓢ, tenants must adhere to their regulations.

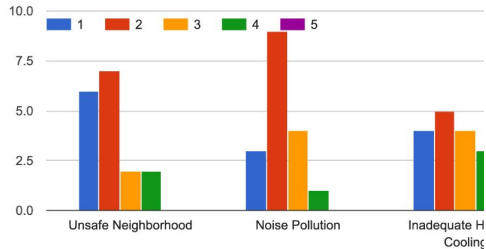
← 1.1 Where to Find Housing

1.3 How to Identify a Scam →

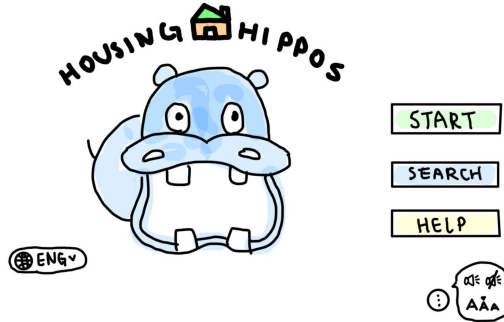
TIMELINE

Preliminary Research

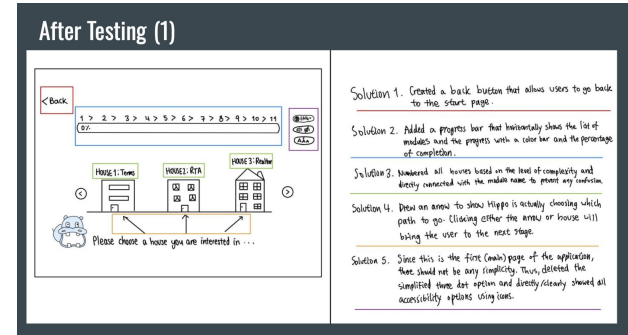
Please rate your experience with the following environmental



Early Designs

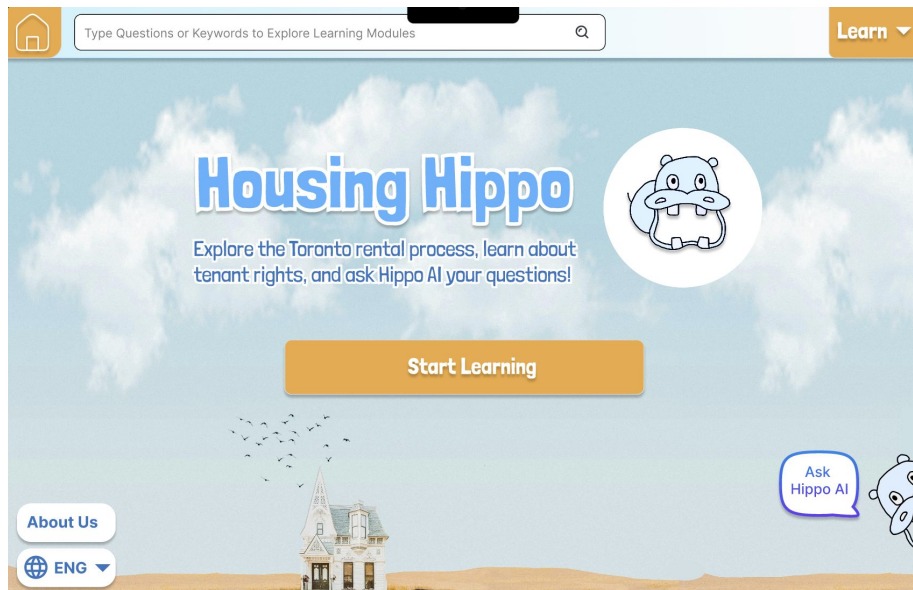


Early User Testing



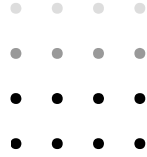
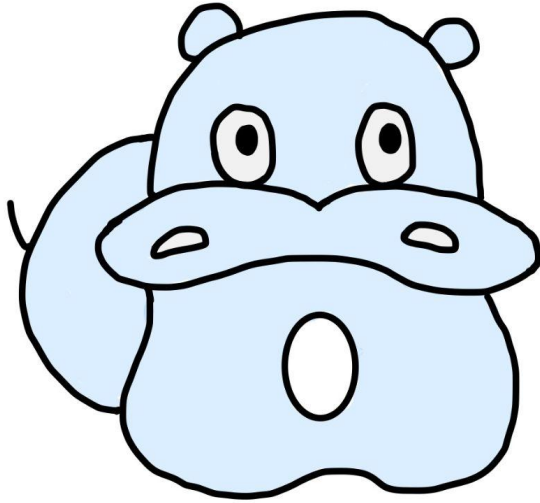
TIMELINE

Refined Design



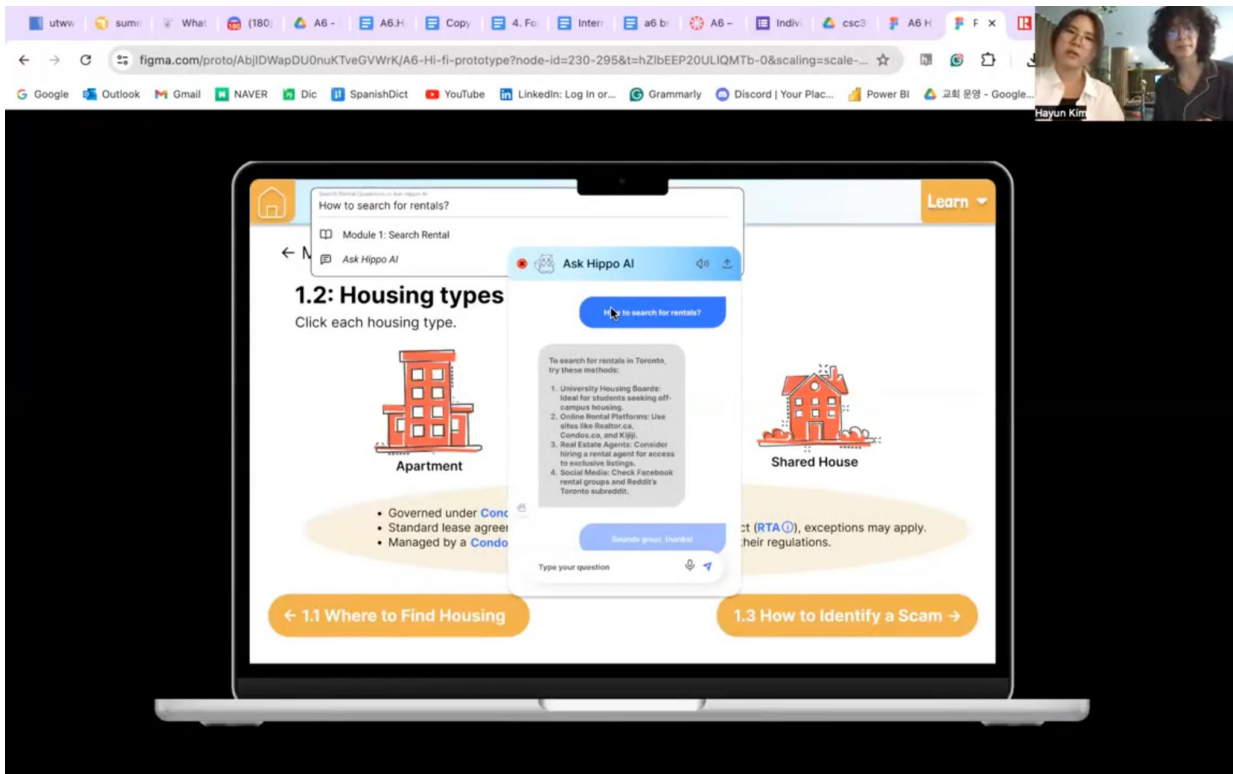
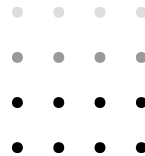
Interactive User Testing

The screenshot shows the "Module 1: Search Rental" page. It has a navigation bar at the top with a home icon, a search bar, and a "Learn" button. Below the navigation bar, the text "Module 1: Search Rental" is displayed, followed by the sub-header "1.1: Where to Find Housing" and the instruction "Click each resource to see their advantages." There are three buttons: "Realtor.ca", "School Housing Website", and "Condos.ca". At the bottom right, there is an orange button labeled "1.2 Housing Types in Toronto".	- Clicked realtor.ca first - Not sure what is CREA but want to know - Would like to compare all 3 resources in real time → she forgets
The screenshot shows the "Module 1: Search Rental" page, specifically the "1.2: Housing Types in Toronto" section. It has a navigation bar at the top with a home icon, a search bar, and a "Learn" button. Below the navigation bar, the text "Module 1: Search Rental" is displayed, followed by the sub-header "1.2: Housing Types in Toronto" and the instruction "Click each housing type." There are three buttons: "Apartment", "Condo", and "Shared House". At the bottom left, there is an orange button labeled "1.1 Where to Find Housing", and at the bottom right, there is an orange button labeled "1.3 How to Identify a Scam".	- Compare apt and condo back and forth - Didn't even see caption, but just clicked - Might have directly clicked 1.3 - Apt: when is a landlord responsible? Would like to know - She doesn't <u>rely</u> want to know condominium act - More interest in exceptions and regulations for tenants



Are users
actually
satisfied?

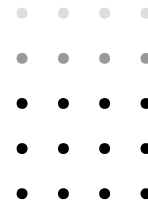
USER TESTING



1-on-1

9 participants

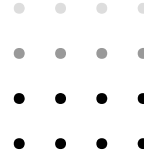
TASKS



01 Access our education content

02 Navigate & complete our education content

03 Use our chatbot to ask a question



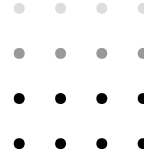
“HIPPO IS CUTE!
Contents are also
really interactive and
easy to understand.”



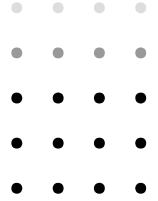
– A 2nd year student, moving off-campus soon

“I prefer searching for housing questions here [Housing Hippos] over using Google”

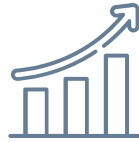
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WITH HOUSING HIPPO



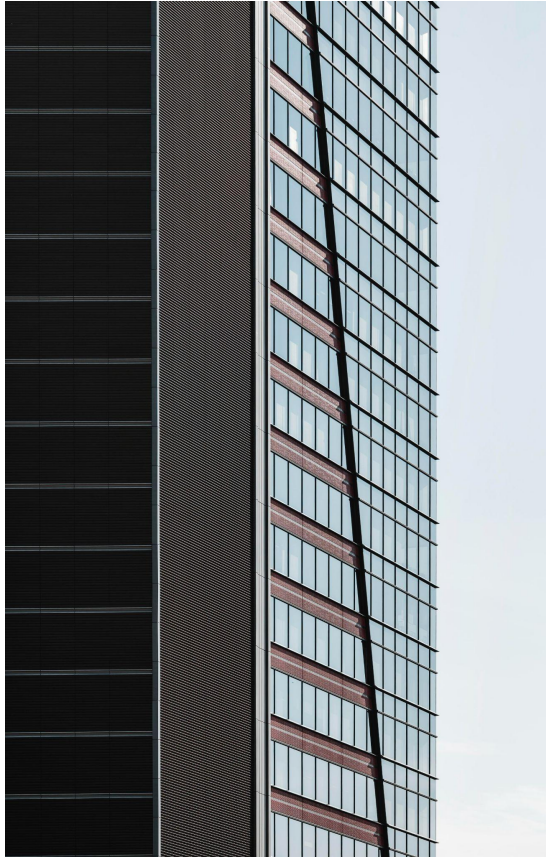
Mental
Health



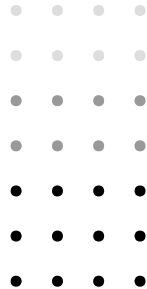
Academic
Success



Financial
Security



Made by students For students!



DANKE SHÖN